



Into to Web Accessibility

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What is accessibility (A11y)?

- Ensuring there are no barriers for users with disabilities or users using assistive technologies like screen readers, magnifiers,
 - An equivalent experience
- Different from usability is an efficient pleasant experience for all users
 - Usability issues affect *all* users and are things we commonly test and talk through in product conversations

Why is this important

- People with disabilities deserve to be able to use our products
 - 10-20% of the population, depending on how you measure
 - 30-60% of older people have some disability
- Increased market
- Legal liability
- Improves SEO
- Accessible practices benefit *all users*.
- Many people end up temporarily disabled

Accessibility issues do NOT feel like being a kid lost in a department store, but like a grocery store with confusing organization and blocked aisles. NOT confusing; FRUSTRATING.

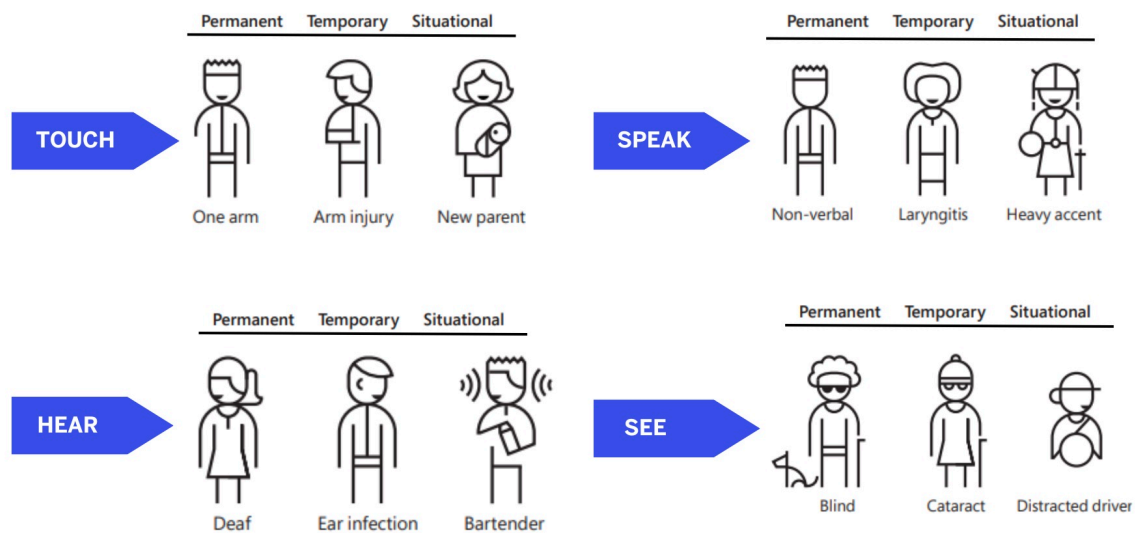
Why is it specifically important for Homeaglow

- Our business may specifically benefit since people with disabilities may benefit more from home cleaning & other services
- People with low english-language skills (like non-english speaking cleaners) also benefit from changes in language/complexity made for people with cognitive disabilities

Types of disabilities

- **Temporary vs Permanent vs Situational**
- Physical → Blindness, low vision, colorblindness, deafness, limited mobility
- Cognitive → wide variety, but commonalities may include limited comprehension, limited problem solving skills, short term memory loss, attention issues

DISABILITY IS A SPECTRUM



Source: Microsoft Inclusive Design Toolkit

A11y engineering resources

It's a lot quicker to consider a11y when designing and implementing a component than to fix it later

Patterns

Accessibility resources free online from the international

<https://www.w3.org/WAI/ARIA/apg/patterns/>



Web Accessibility Initiative

Web Accessibility: Essential for some, useful for all

WebAIM: Articles

You are here: Home > Articles

<https://webaim.org/articles/>

A beginner's audit

A Definitive Guide On How To Do An Accessibility Audit • DigitalA11Y

This definitive guide blog post outlines the steps and considerations for performing an accessibility audit. You will learn how to assess the accessibility of a website, the tools and techniques you can use, and the

 <https://www.digitala11y.com/a-definitive-guide-on-how-to-perform-a-web-accessibility-audit/#text-content>



The goal is to make a website perceivable, operable, understandable, and robust

How to Meet WCAG (Quickref Reference)

Note: Clear Filters will not change the selected version.

 <https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/>

Without knowing how to use assistive technology like screen readers, you can do some easy things to make a lot of progress

Browser Extensions & tools

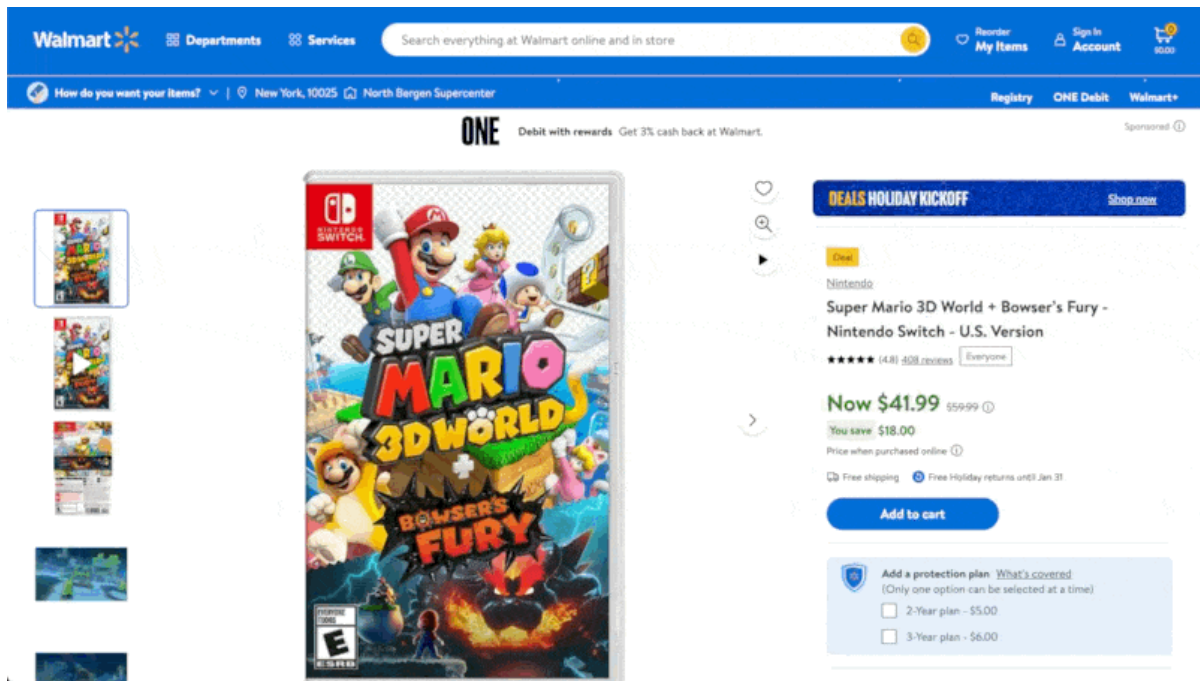
- [Accessibility insights](#)
 - accessibility names
- [WAVE](#)
- [axe DevTools](#)
- [Web Disability Simulator](#)
- OS screen reader

Page titles

- First thing screen readers read.
- Unique and descriptive
- Should show result of user action

Keyboard navigation

- You should be able to access all areas of the page and complete all actions with a keyboard **only. There are sighted keyboard users too**
- Visual focus indicator that doesn't get hidden behind content on scroll



<https://www.deque.com/blog/give-site-focus-tips-designing-usable-focus-indicators/>

- Focus should be intentionally moved in multi-step flows
- Beware of focus traps

Headings

- Heading order should represent page structure and not skip levels

When trying to find information on a lengthy web page, which of the following are you most likely to do first?

Response	# of respondents	% of respondents
Navigate through the headings on the page	1047	67.7%
Read through the page	126	8.1%
Use the Find feature	215	13.9%
Navigate through the links of the page	110	7.1%
Navigate through the landmarks/regions of the page	49	3.2%

- Things that look like headings are HTML headings
- Things that are not headings shouldn't look like headings
 - HTML headings shouldn't be used just for styling
- One H1 element on the page, should be as similar as possible to the page `<title>`

Non-text content

- Images MUST have descriptive `alt` text
 - This includes icons, anything in an `img` or `svg` tag
- Only purely decorative images may not have `alt` text (like background images that don't convey meaning)

Colors

- There are 3x as many people with low vision as fully-blind.
- Situational low-vision like outside or on a screen with a heavy glare.

Don't use color alone to convey meaning

- For example, charts with colored lines/legend
- Error messages at the top of the form with color only designating it as an error
- Is **link text** distinguishable from non-link text by something other than color?

Color Contrast

- Minimum text contrast of 4.5:1 (3:1 for large text)

Web Disability Simulator

Simulates how people with disabilities experience the web

 <https://chrome.google.com/webstore/detail/web-disability-simulator/olioanlbgbpmdlgjnnampnnlohigkja>



Links

- Links should be semantically correct, as in they should take a user somewhere
- Link purpose must be programmatically determinable, and SHOULD be identifiable without context

Buttons

- Buttons should do an action
- Don't just use a div with an `onClick` handler, use the native `<button>` !
 - Custom buttons need to be focusable, readable, and respond to key press

HTML5 Accessibility Chops: Just use a (native HTML) button - TPGi

Many User interface widgets can be developed using HTML, CSS and JavaScript, in some cases developers build custom versions of native HTML controls because they cannot achieve the exact look...

 <https://www.tpgi.com/html5-accessibility-chops-just-use-a-button/>



Tables

- Tables should be used for data only
- Tables should have a caption and column/row headers
 - headers MUST be designated with a `th` element

Harder things...

Forms

- All form elements must have a visible label that is associated with the input
 - Labels for groups of inputs
- Errors should be helpful and associated with relevant inputs
- Instructions and hints, where necessary
- Error prevention
- Form validation

Loading content

Lazy loaded content

- Placeholders for lazy loading content SHOULD inform screen reader users that the content is loading.

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- Lazy loading content SHOULD NOT be announced as it loads.

Loading indicators on user actions

The worst thing that screen reader users can hear after activating a button is silence.

- Screen reader users MUST be informed when a web page launches an interstitial view, a progress indicator, or enters into a paused or busy state.
 - Move the focus to the interstitial message OR
 - Announce the interstitial message via an ARIA live region

Button with accessible loading/confirmation states

 <https://codepen.io/smhigley/pen/GRvOevx>

Loading/Confirmation button

Quick example of an accessible implementation of a button that has loading and confirmation states after it is activated.

Example

Message:

Save

Accessibility approach

- An icon rather than a text label: Icons are easy to miss if using a screen reader, or if the user has something that causes tunnel vision or tunnel focus. A loading spinner icon on the button shows up right when clicked and keyboard focus already exists.
- A visually hidden status message: It would also be possible to give the icon an accessible name, and rely on the name change on the focused element. The icon will then approach is that some changes are not consistently read by screen readers, and it is also possible that the user has moved focus before the confirmation click. An accessible name change approach with a status message would make it double announcements. The user would see to say only on a status message, and receive the status as visually.
- Use an aria-disabled instead of disabled: If the button is disabled to (1) add other activation, focus would be lost. Using an aria-disabled allows focus to remain on the button after it is pressed.
- Loading timeout: There is a 200ms timeout on the loading announcement that is cleared if the saved state occurs before the 200ms is up. That prevents the loading state from being announced if it is so brief that the extra announcement would be unnecessary.

Other resources

Basic Accessibility Checklist | Michigan State University

Basic Accessibility Checklist

 <https://webaccess.msu.edu/tutorials/basics/checklist>

Beginner's A11y Checklist